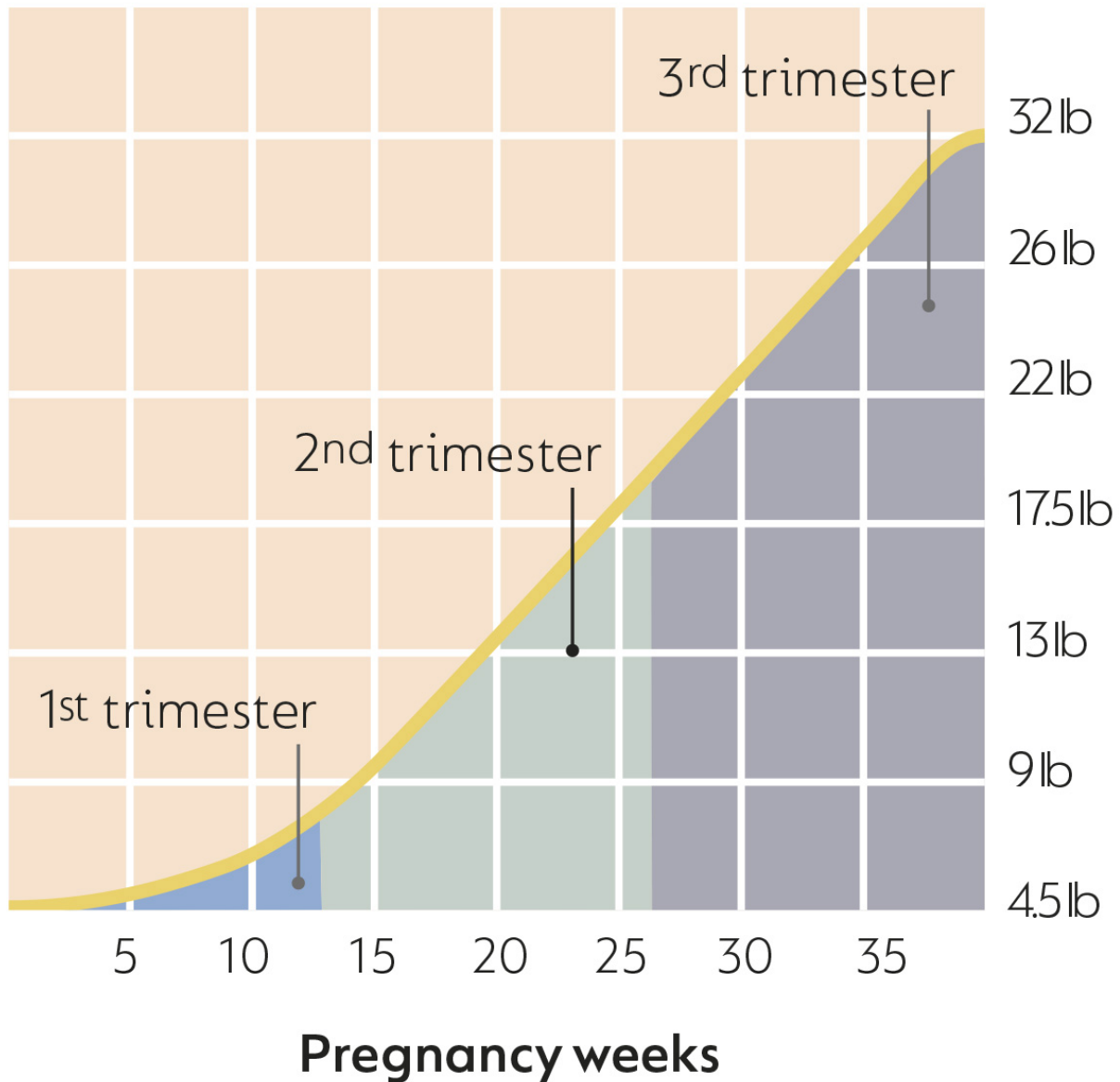


Weight-gain chart



ASK A DOCTOR

I keep having hot flashes. Is this normal? Many women experience hot flashes during pregnancy as a result of increased levels of the hormone estrogen. This encourages the blood vessels to dilate—suffusing them with blood and heat. What’s more, when you’re pregnant, your metabolism increases, causing extra heat to be produced. That’s not to mention the little heater that you have growing inside you.

Wear layers that can be speedily removed and avoid eating spicy foods and drinking alcohol and caffeine, all of which can encourage hot flashes. Exercise can help by improving circulation, and yoga and other relaxation exercises can help you to keep cool and calm.